

# ART & CULTURE



## RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

### MODULE - 2

### HINDUISM AND ITS PHILOSOPHY



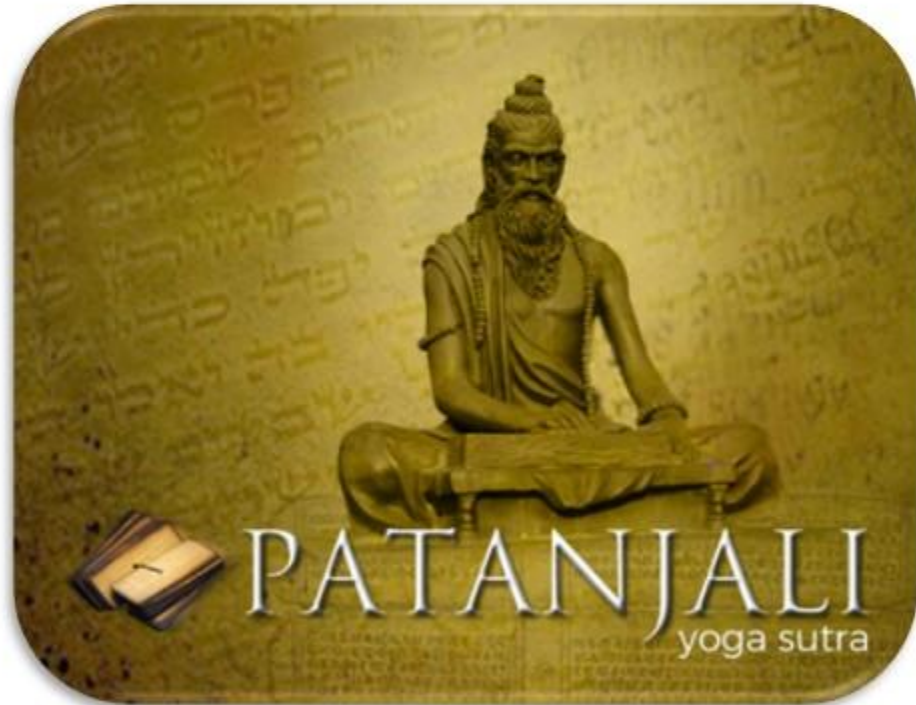
# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

2

YOGA

FOUNDER – PATANJALI'S  
YOGA SUTRA



- 1 The origin of yoga is found in the Yogasutra of Patanjali.
- 2 By purifying and controlling changes in the mental mechanism, **yoga** systematically brings about the release of purusha from prakriti.
- 3 Yogic **techniques** control the body, mind and sense organs. Thus this philosophy is also considered a means of **achieving freedom or mukti**.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

2

YOGA

### SIMILARITY BETWEEN YOGA AND SAMKHYA

- 4
- The Yoga philosophy quite like the Samkhya, **does not derive its source of origin from Vedas.**
  - Like Samkhya, it believe the cosmos to be a result of **interaction between Purusha and Prakriti.**
  - It also believes in existence of the **three Gunas.**

### DISSIMILARITY BETWEEN YOGA AND SAMKHYA

- 5
- However, while in the Samkhya system, there is a **lesser role for Purusha** towards his liberation, in the Yoga system, Purusha is not a mere spectator and by **personal effort and practical action through yoga asanas**, Purusha can attain his own liberation.
- 6
- Yoga admits the existence of God as a teacher and guide, whereas, Samkhya does not believe in the existence of god.



## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

2

YOGA



**7** The **Ashtanga Yoga** as propounded by **Patanjali** is the means to such liberation.

8

It consists of eight limbs which are:

- 1. Yama** – comprising Ahimsa, eschewing Asatya (falsehood), Aparigraha (greed/envy), Asteya (acquisition) and practicing Brahmacharya (sexual restraint)
- 2. Niyama** – discipline and observance of rules of simplicity, austerity, and purity
- 3. Asana** – physical postures and exercises
- 4. Pranayama** – control of breath and mind
- 5. Pratyahara** – withdrawal of consciousness/mind from sensory objects
- 6. Dharana** – concentration
- 7. Dhyana** – meditation
- 8. Samadhi** – state of union of self with universe or Kaivalya.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

### 2 YOGA

9 Yoga is recognised by the Hindu philosophy to be categorised as:

**Raja Yoga**

Described in Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga. It is viewed as the "royal path" to attaining state of yoga or unity with mind-body-spirit.

**Jnana Yoga**

This is known as Buddhi Yoga, where salvation is attained through knowledge

**Karma Yoga**

Here, the world of everyday work becomes the tool by which self is transcended.

**Bhakti Yoga**

Here, Moksha is attained through devotional service to god.



## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

FOUNDER – GAUTAMA'S  
NYAYA SUTRA

1 Nyaya is considered as a **technique of logical thinking**.

2 According to Nyaya, **valid knowledge is defined as the real knowledge**, that is, one knows about the object as it exists.

3 For example, it is when one knows a snake as a snake or a cup as a cup.

4 They also believe that God not only created universe but also had the powers to sustain and destroy it.



7 The most important contribution made by the school is the **system of logic** that has subsequently been adopted by majority of the Indian schools.

6 They argue that by using **logical tools like inference, hearing, and analogy** a human being could verify the truth of a statement.

5 Further more they argue that acquiring "**real knowledge**" can only **accrue salvation**.

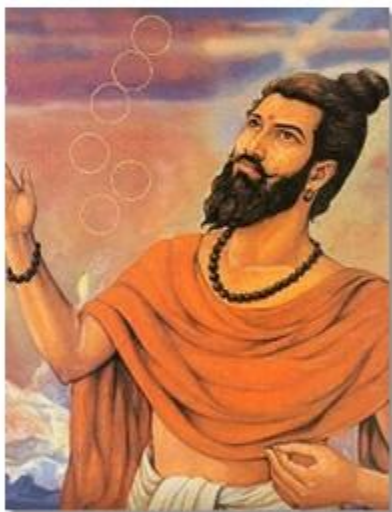


# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

### 4 VAISHESHIKA

**FOUNDER – MAHARISHI KANNADA'S  
VAISESIKA-SUTRA**



- 1 Vaisheshika system believes in the **physicality of universe** and is considered as the realistic and objective philosophy of universe.

- 2 It postulates matter and objects in the physical world to be eventually made up of Parmanu (atoms).

- 3 As this school has a very scientific approach, they also developed the **atomic theory** i.e., all material objects are made up of atoms.

- 4 They explained that the basis for everything that can be physically touched or seen is made up of atoms and molecules, thus this school was also responsible for the **beginning of physics** in India.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

### 4 VAISHESHIKA



- 5 Vaisheshika thinkers believe that all objects of the universe are composed of **five elements** – earth, water, air, fire and ether.

- 6 They believe that **God** is the guiding principle.
- 7 The living beings were rewarded or punished according to the **law of karma**, based on **actions of merit and demerit**.
- 8 They also believed in **salvation, creation and destruction of universe** was a cyclic process and took place in agreement with the wishes of God.



# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

5

MIMAMSA

### FOUNDER – JAMINI'S MIMAMSA SUTRA

1 Mimamsa philosophy is basically the **art of reasoning, interpretation and application.**

2 This school focuses on the usage of the text of the **Samhita and Brahmana portions** of the Veda.

3 Thus, this school of philosophy is based on the teachings of Vedas as contained in Samhitas and Brahmanas.

4 It considers **Vedas to be eternal** and infallible and possess all knowledge, and **religion means the fulfilment of duties** prescribed by the Vedas.

5 This philosophy **encompasses the Nyaya- Vaisheshika systems** and emphasizes the **concept of valid knowledge.**

6 Its main text is known as the Sutras of Jaimini which have been written during the third century BC.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

5

MIMAMSA

- 7 Further this philosophy was developed by two of the greatest proponents - Sabar Swami and Kumarila Bhatta.



- Afterlife and Reincarnation
- Karma (Actions)
- Dharma (Righteousness)

- 8 The essence of the system according to Jaimini is Dharma which is the dispenser of fruits of one's actions, the law of righteousness itself.

- 9 One's actions were responsible for their merits and demerits and a person would enjoy the bliss of heaven as long as their meritorious acts lasted.

- 10 Once they achieve salvation, they would be able to break free from this unending cycle.



# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

5

MIMAMSA



*This was used as a device by the Brahmins to maintain their clout over people and they continued to dominate the social hierarchy.*

**11** This system lays stress on the **ritualistic part of Vedas**, i.e. to achieve salvation one has to perform the Vedic rituals.

**12** As most humans did not understand the rituals properly they would have to take **assistance of the priests**.

**13** Therefore, this philosophy inherently **legitimized the social distance between the various classes**.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

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VEDANTA

FOUNDER – BADRAYANA'S  
BRAHMASUTRAS



**BADRAYANA**

- 1 Vedanta implies the philosophy of the Upanishad, the concluding portion of the Vedas.

- 2 Vedanta means the end of Vedas.

- 3 The philosophy propounds that brahma is the reality of life and everything else is unreal or Maya.

- 4 Furthermore, the atma or the consciousness of self is similar to the brahma.

- 5 This argument equalizes atma and brahma and if a person attains the knowledge of the self, he would automatically understand brahma and would achieve salvation.

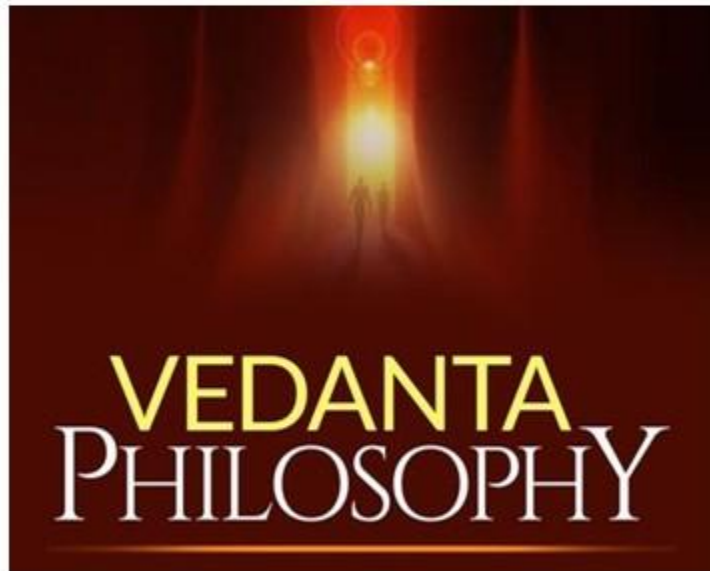


# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

6

VEDANTA



6

The Vedanta school branched out into separate sub-schools based on their philosophies. Some of these schools are:

1. Advaita
2. Vishishta Advaita
3. Dvaita
4. Bheda abheda
5. Neo-Vedanta etc..

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

6

VEDANTA

### ADVAITA VEDANTA – ABSOLUTE MONISM



1 Advaita literally means 'no two' or sole or unity.

2 Thus, this school of philosophy is based on **principle of monism** that all creation is a reflection of the supreme.

3 Thus, **soul was not a separate entity from the Brahma** but only its manifestation.

4 Sri **Adi Shankaracharya** (8<sup>th</sup> century CE) consolidated the principles of Advaita Vedanta and structured the philosophy in a formal shape.



# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

6

VEDANTA

### ADVAITA VEDANTA – ABSOLUTE MONISM



ADI SHANKARACHARYA

- 5 Shankaracharya expounded that **ultimate reality is one**, it being the Brahman.

- 6 According to his philosophy, **Brahman is true**, the world is **false** and self and Brahman are not different.

- 7 Shankaracharya believes that the Brahman is existent, unchanging, **the highest truth and the ultimate knowledge**.

- 8 The knowledge of Brahman is the essence of all things and the ultimate existence.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

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VEDANTA

### VISHIST ADVAITA VEDANTA – QUALIFIED MONISM



**RAMANUJA**

- 1 This philosophy was propounded by **Ramanuja**.

- 2 Although it does consider **Jivatama** (soul-living being) to be a reflection of the **Brahma**, however, unlike Advaita school, it does not consider the **Brahma** to be without attributes.

- 3 Thus, **Brahma is Saguna** (with attributes) whereas, in Advaita philosophy **Brahma is Nirguna** (without attributes).

- 4 This philosophy and teachings of Ramanuja also laid the foundation of **Vaishnavism**.



## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

6

VEDANTA

## DVAITA- DUALISM



MADHAVACHARYA

- 1 **Madhavacharya** was the propounder of this school of philosophy.
- 2 It considered **Brahma** (the Universal) and **Atma** (soul) to be **two distinct** entities.
- 3 Brahma is also identified with attributes which was considered to be Lord Vishnu with various incarnations.
- 4 It emphasises on '**Bhakti**' as means for salvation of the soul.

## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

6

VEDANTA

### BHEDA – ABHEDA



**NIMBARKA**

- 1 The word Bheda – abheda literally means 'difference and no difference'.

- 3 It propounds that Brahman (universal/supreme) and Jivatma (soul-living being) are distinct and different and yet not different from each other.

- 4 It says that jivatman is at once the same as yet different from Brahman. The jiva relation may be regarded as dvaita from one point of view and advaita from another.

- 5 Bhaskara and Nimbarka (whose Dvaitadvaita philosophy was very much similar to this school) were important teachers of this school.



## VEDIC PHILOSOPHY

6

VEDANTA

### NEO – VEDANTA



- 1 This modern interpretation of Vedanta emerged in the 19<sup>th</sup> and 20<sup>th</sup> century.
- 2 This is the result of thinkers and philosophers like Sri Ramakrishna, Sri Vivekananda, Sri Aurobindo, and other philosophers and teachers.

# RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

Vedanta philosophy teaches that all these different religions are **like so many roads, which lead to same goal.**

The core message of Vedanta is that every action must be governed by the **intellect of the human being.**

Vedanta is a **philosophy and a religion** as it inculcates the highest truths that have been discovered by the greatest philosophers of the world.

It has to some extent **killed the human ego**, and has attained its unique position in the history of philosophies of the world.

Among different schools of philosophy, one philosophy which reached the climax of philosophic thought that the human mind can possibly reach, and that is known as the Vedantic philosophy.

The **mind** makes mistakes but the **intellect** tells us if the action is in our interest or not.

Vedanta enables the practitioner to **access the ultimate spirit** through the intellect.

**UNIQUENESS OF VEDANTA PHILOSOPHY**



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